

Istanbul Bilgi University - Music Department

Guidelines for MUS 441 Senior Project I & MUS 442 Senior Project II

2025-2026 Fall & Spring

The Aim

A senior project aims to demonstrate a student's creative inclinations and their realization through the knowledge, techniques, and critical skills acquired during their studies and present a coherent artistic outcome.

The process of a senior project is as important as the outcome: meeting with the project advisor on a weekly basis, coming to the meetings prepared and ready to explore new pathways, and being vigilant about timelines and deadlines. Those are the skills and competencies that the professors will regard highly when assessing your project.

The senior year students will choose one of the project categories described in this document in order to accomplish MUS 441 and MUS 442 courses.

Senior Project Timeline

The following timeline is the main structure of the Senior Project for the whole year. These dates and deadlines are crucial, and it is every student's own responsibility to complete the given task on time, not anyone else's.

- Announcements of guidelines and deadlines (**September 26th, 2025**)
- Preparation and submission of proposals (MUS 441) (**October 12th, 2025, 23:59**)
- Proposal assessments and revisions (MUS 441)
- Advisor assignments (MUS 441) (**October 15th, 2025**)
- **Fall Term** - Weekly meetings
- Submission of projects and project reports (MUS 441 & MUS 442) (**January 2nd, 2026, 23:59**)
- Project presentations and Grading (MUS 441 & MUS 442) (**January 8th-9th, 2026**)
- **Spring Term** – Weekly Meetings
- Submission of projects and project reports (MUS 441 & MUS 442) (**June 5th, 2026, 10:00**)
- Project presentations and Grading (MUS 441 & MUS 442) (**June 11th-12th, 2026**)

Project Proposal

The proposal should include the information below.

- The project category they have chosen. (See the last part of this document, page 4.)
- The reason for this choice.
- Their expectations of the outcome.
- Their methods and tools (How they want to carry out the process).
- A detailed timeline that states where they expect to be in the process every month.

For more information about how to write a proposal, please check:

<http://www.dummies.com/how-to/content/how-to-plan-your-dissertation-proposal.html> or

There can be some changes during the realization of the project. However, the category and the main description submitted in the proposal cannot change. If a student wants to do so, they must write a new proposal and submit it to the jury members.

Students should also indicate the advisor they wish to work with. It is better to indicate a second name in case the preferred advisor is unavailable.

The proposal should be uploaded to the assignment page of MUS 441 before the given deadline.

Project Proposal Assessment

The jury consisting of advisors Tolga Tüzün, Oğuz Usman, Enis Gümüş, Yiğit Özatalay, Cem Ömeroğlu, and Semin Tunalı will evaluate the proposals. In case of need, the jury can require an interview with the student. The jury may ask for minor or major changes or reject the project entirely.

In case of rejection, the student will prepare another proposal in three days, considering the comments that the jury provided.

The jury will assign the advisors according to their specialty and their workload.

Meetings

The student should schedule an appointment with their advisor immediately after the announcement of the proposal results. They will meet weekly for the rest of the semester to work on the project.

For this period, the advisors will report students' attendance and progress. If a student fails to meet the advisor less than 70% of the weeks during the term, they will automatically fail the course and won't be accepted to the final presentations.

MUS 441

During the final examination period of the Fall semester, the student will present the progress and the latest state of the project in front of the jury.

The jury will give a final grade for MUS 441 by considering the advisor's opinions about the appointments, the student's submitted project file, and the final presentation.

The student must submit all the materials (notation, recordings, etc.) for the MUS 441 presentation before the deadline. (Notation is a must, even if it is not in the final format.)

Even if the student registers for the senior project as an irregular (meaning, MUS 441 during the Spring term and MUS 442 during the following fall term), the exact dates and deadlines indicated in the timeline apply.

MUS 442

During the Spring semester, the student will continue with the weekly meetings and work on the project.

The student must submit the final version of the senior project for the MUS 442 presentation before the deadline. In addition to recording and notations, the student also submits a paper describing the whole senior project process. This paper should be the final version approved by the advisor.

The student must meet the criteria for each category, including the given duration for the project, proper notation/lead sheets, and a proper report in general (especially details of the project, including who-did-what info). If the student doesn't meet these criteria, the project will not be accepted for presentations, the student will fail the course, and the process will have to be repeated.

The final presentation is open to all BilgiMusic students.

We wish you a creative year.

Project Categories

- **Orchestral composition**

Requirements: To be able to show a thorough understanding of historical and compositional practices of orchestral writing; competency in harmony, notation, composition, and MIDI realization.

Duration: Approx. 15 minutes of written music.

Recommended Courses: Students are advised to have a passing grade from the following courses.

MUS 311, MUS 244, MUS 374, MUS 375, MUS 376

- **Small Ensemble composition (4-8 players) (acoustic or mixed with electroacoustic)**

Requirements: To be able to show a thorough understanding of historical and compositional practices of chamber music, and competency in harmony, notation, composition, and recording.

Duration: Approx. 20 minutes of written music.

Recommended Courses: Students are advised to have a passing grade from the following courses.

MUS 311, MUS 244, MUS 374, MUS 375, MUS 376

- **Album Production**

Requirements: To be able to show professional competency in arranging, recording, mixing, and mastering.

Duration: Minimum 5 songs. (Approx. 15 minutes)

Scores/lead sheets of the pieces are required. Your project will not be accepted to the final presentation without them.

The songs that are to be produced should be presented with the proposal. No composing time will be allocated in the timetable. The final mixes should reflect industry-standard quality.

Recommended Courses: Students are advised to have a passing grade from the following courses.

MUS 244, MUS 261, MUS 437, MUS 378

- **Songwriting**

Requirements: To be able to show professional competency in songwriting, composition, and arranging.

Duration: Minimum 5 songs. (Approx. 15 minutes)

Scores/lead sheets of the pieces are required.

Rough mixes will be accepted.

Recommended Courses: Students are advised to have a passing grade from the following courses.

MUS 261, MUS 375, MUS 376, MUS 394

- **Sound Installation and Multimedia Projects**

Requirements: To be able to show a thorough understanding of historical and compositional practices of electroacoustic music, sound art, and multimedia; competency in electroacoustic composition, sound design/performance, and programming.

Duration (if applicable): Approx. 15 minutes.

Recommended Courses: Students are advised to have a passing grade from the following courses.

MUS 230, MUS 244, MUS 367, MUS 380, MUS 388

- **Other Projects**

Projects that don't fit the aforementioned categories will be evaluated case by case. The proposal should carry exceptionally convincing arguments as to why the student wants to choose a separate category.